The Talent Hunt

Building a career in the luxury sector requires commercial acumen, cultural understanding, and the ability to deliver exceptional customer experiences

BY **MAMTA SHARMA**

IMAGE BY **NILANJAN DAS/AI**

PEOPLE RARELY REMEMBER what a brand sold them. They remember how the experience felt. This is a lesson the Assistant Business Development Manager at BlackCab Agency Network, Parth Sathe, started understanding through internships across hospitality and automotive retail.

Before enrolling in the Global Luxury Goods & Services Management programme offered by S. P. Jain School of Global Management in collaboration with POLIMI Graduate School of Management, Sathe associated luxury with exclusivity and beautifully crafted products. He had yet to appreciate the work that went into making an experience appear effortless. "A smooth evening or a well-run launch looks easy because a lot of people have sorted out every detail well in advance," he says.

The shift in perspective reflects a broader change in how the luxury industry is understood. Beyond fashion and design, luxury spans hospitality, travel, beauty, retail and premium experiences, creating opportunities in areas such as brand management, merchandising, client relations and digital commerce. As India's luxury market evolves, the challenge is not simply to find people who admire luxury brands but to also build a workforce that understands the business behind them and knows how to translate a brand's promise into an experience for which people are willing to spend.

BEYOND FASHION AND DESIGN

Gianluca Tedaldi, Director at POLIMI Graduate School of Management, says the luxury industry is at a turning point. While Europe has historically been its centre of gravity, he sees markets such as India playing an increasingly important role in its future growth. The industry needs more than designers and creative professionals, he says. It requires managers who understand a brand's heritage and can translate it for different markets, he adds.

Beyond fashion and design, opportunities span retail and client experience, brand management, market development, merchandising, luxury hospitality, and the business of craft and manufacturing. The common thread, says Tedaldi, is cultural fluency: understanding the history and codes of luxury while helping shape its future.

Nitish Jain, Founder and President of S. P. Jain School of Global Management, sees the range of